



2nd Grade Pattern Games

Patterns are very important in math. They help children learn how to recognize structure and predict what comes next and how to problem solve. This is early algebra where something is repeating or changing in a rule-based way.

1. Copy Me Game (2 or more players)

Objective

To follow and repeat a pattern.

Game Play

1. Players sit in a circle or around a table.
2. Choose one player to start
3. Player 1 creates a pattern using at least 3-4 actions (e.g. clap twice, tap your head once).
4. Everyone repeats the pattern together several times.
4. Choose a new player to create the next pattern.

Challenge

Create a pattern with 4-5 or more actions.

2. Pattern Detective (2 players)

Objective

To find the mistake in a pattern.

Materials

Paper and pencil

Small objects like cereal or counter for support if needed

Game Play

1. Choose who will be the first to make a pattern.
2. Player 1 creates a pattern with one mistake in it.
Example: 5, 10, 15, 17, 20, 25

2. Player 2 finds the mistake and explains it.
3. Switch roles and play again.

3. Pattern Switch Game (2 players)

Objective

To notice when a pattern changes.

Game Play

1. Choose who goes first.
2. Player 1 starts a pattern and then changes it.

Example: 2, 4, 6, 8, 10 and then switches to 10, 20, 30, 40

3. The other player must explain the new pattern.
4. Switch roles and play again.

4. Pattern Treasure Hunt

Objective

To solve patterns to find clues.

Materials

4-6 index cards or small pieces of paper

Pencil or pen

Setup

Write a pattern on each card with a blank to fill in. Write a location to find the next clue.

Example Clues:

Easier

Example 1: 5, 10, 15, 20, _____. Go to the place where you brush your teeth. (This is where the next pattern will be.)

Example 2: 22, 21, 20, 19, _____. Go to the place where you clean dishes.

Example 3: ○ ○ □ ○ ○ □ _____. Look under your bed.

Harder

Example 1: 41, 43, 45, _____, 49, 51. Go the place where you keep your favorite book.

Example 2: 17, 22, 27, 32 ____ . Go to the place where you put your dirty clothes.

Example 3:  ____ . Go to the place where you keep your favorite toy.

Challenge

Example 1: 103, 106, 109, ____ 115, 118. Go the place where you keep your favorite book.

Example 2: A A B C A A B C A A __ C. Go to the place where the cat drinks.

Example 3: 1, 2, 4, 5, 7, 8, 10, 11 ____ (+1, +2) . Go to the place where you get cereal.

Game Play

1. Give your child the first clue.
2. They solve the pattern.
3. Confirm the problem has been solved correctly.
4. Have them read or you read aloud the location of the next clue.
5. Go find the clue to the next pattern!
6. Continue until the final clue has been found.
7. Celebrate with a silly dance.

5) Pattern Path – Race to 30

Objective

To be the first to reach 30.

Materials

2 game pieces (coins, small pieces of pasta, etc.)

Paper game board with spaces 1-30

1 die

Game Play

1. Roll the die to choose the pattern rule for both players.

1 → +1

2 → +2

3 → +3

4 → +4

5 → +5

6 → +6

2. Both players place their marker on that number (e.g. roll 4, players put markers on the 4 space).

3. Turn Play

A. Die Roll

If the roll die is 1-3, players move forward 1 jump.

If the roll die is 4-6, players move forward 2 jumps.

B. Say Pattern Aloud

Players must say the pattern correctly before moving forward.

4. Players take turns.

6. The first player to reach 30 or more wins.

6) Pattern Kingdom – Race to 50

Objective

To be the first player to reach 50 or more

Materials

Paper game board with spaces 1-50

2 dice

Game pieces

Game Play

1. Each turn has 3 steps:

a. Roll the first die

This is the pattern rule.

Example: Roll a 3. Your pattern for this turn is +3.

b. Roll the second die.

This tells you how many steps to move.

Roll 1-3, move 1 step in the pattern

Roll 4-6, move 2 steps in the pattern

c. Say the pattern.

Say the pattern and move.

Example.

A. Start at 3

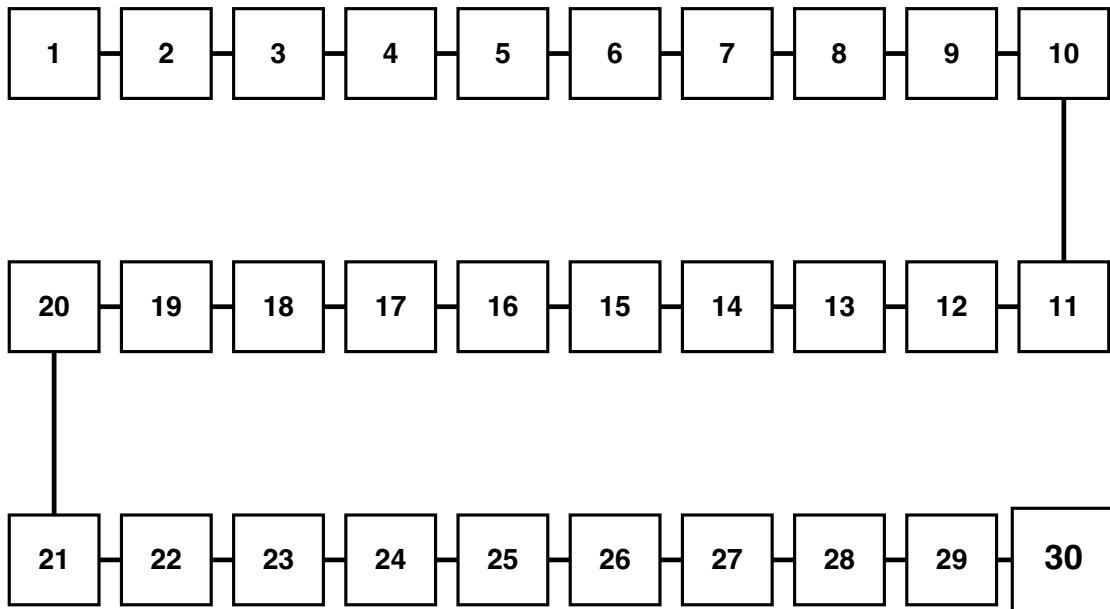
B. Die Roll 1 is a 3. This means the pattern is +3.

C. Die Roll 2 is a 5. This means move 2 steps in the pattern.

D. Say, "The pattern is plus 3. Following the pattern my two steps are 6, 9. I move to 9.

2. The first player to reach 50 or more is the winner.

Pattern Path – Race to 30



Pattern Kingdom – Race to 50

